

DLF Riverside is a luxury residential condominium that appears to float on the backwaters,” says Ohri. The major factor for its success was the convenient access to Infopark, Kinfra Park, the Cochin Export Zone, and the fast-developing Smart City at Kakkanad.

While coastal cities encash seafront views, over 146 riverine cities across India have been part of a movement to clean waterfronts and unlock potential in urban areas. Led by the National Institute of Urban Affairs, a think-tank of the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, this movement is currently training stakeholders in river clean-up and eco-sensitive developments.

Solutions range from bio-remediation to unlocking value with green bonds, explains Victor Shinde, head of Climate Centre for Cities. All waterfront clean-up from Mumbai to Kolkata and Chennai, as well as several riverfronts, starts with seeking economic benefit. But, says Shinde, there are few working examples across the country. The Sabarmati waterfront development, for instance, was able to unlock economic value as prices escalated.

Many new waterfront projects tend to copy the solutions executed so far. What Ahmedabad and Varanasi achieved with concretised ghats is now the subject of an experiment with green *ghats* in places like Haridwar which allow more water to drain and seep into aquifers.

The River Cities Alliance, which started as a 30-city mission in 2021, now covers 146 cities and is drawing upon the success of such projects to create a Global River City Alliance. The Kham River restoration mission in Chatrapati Sambhajnagar (Aurangabad) has even won international laurels.

Even in water-starved Gurugram, green promoters such as Ashwani Khurana of Karma Lakelands are seeking used water to refresh Sewage Treatment Plant and use them to create lakes that enhance the value of the development environmentally and economically. He is even working with the National Highways Authority to channel millions of litres of water collected along the highway to recharge aquifers and feed the waterbodies.

In Tamil Nadu, Indian Administrative Service officer Supriya Sahu undertook creation of mangrove islands to protect the eroding coastal waterfronts. These islands in Chennai's Adyar Estuary, among others, have received accolades. But unlike Mumbai, where waterfront efforts by the public sector were used to draw in the private sector for real estate development, Chennai has not evolved a waterfront real estate development plan.

WEALTH FLOWS BACK

The Mumbai model works on economies of scale. The public sector keeps pushing expensive infrastructure projects to allow the private sector to harness that alpha from the market.



“Bandra Bay appeals to buyers who value exclusivity, connectivity, and a lifestyle anchored around waterfront living. Pricing will be benchmarked to premium over Bandra Reclamation”

NIRANJANI HIRANANDANI
CHAIRMAN,
HIRANANDANI GROUP



“This integrated plan will transform an underutilised coastal stretch into Mumbai’s most iconic address—an urban district that harmonises real estate, lifestyle, and public spaces”

SUMESH MISHRA
CO-FOUNDER,
LIGHTHOUSE LUXURY

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When they sell premium properties, the wealth comes back to city coffers in the form of land and property registration fees and higher property taxes in perpetuity. It is imperative for this model to succeed.

While participating in this joint development in the heart of the city, Hiranandani has also committed to another coastal project, Hiranandani Sands, Nagaon, Alibaug. It is a flagship coastal township development, positioned in the luxury home and tourism-hospitality ecosystem-led living. “Unlike the high-rise, high-density Bandra Bay project, it is designed as a future-ready coastal district, combining leisure, living, and long-term investment value,” says Hiranandani. It is a 225-acre integrated coastal township with premium apartments, plotted development, branded serviced apartments, luxe villas, hospitality and recreation zones, and a private-access beach experience.

The risks are not a deterrent. In fact, both are large format projects that will cement Mumbai's place among the Marina cities of the world. Together, Bandra Bay redevelopment and coastal townships like Alibaug's Hiranandani Sands promise to redefine Mumbai's future. **BT**